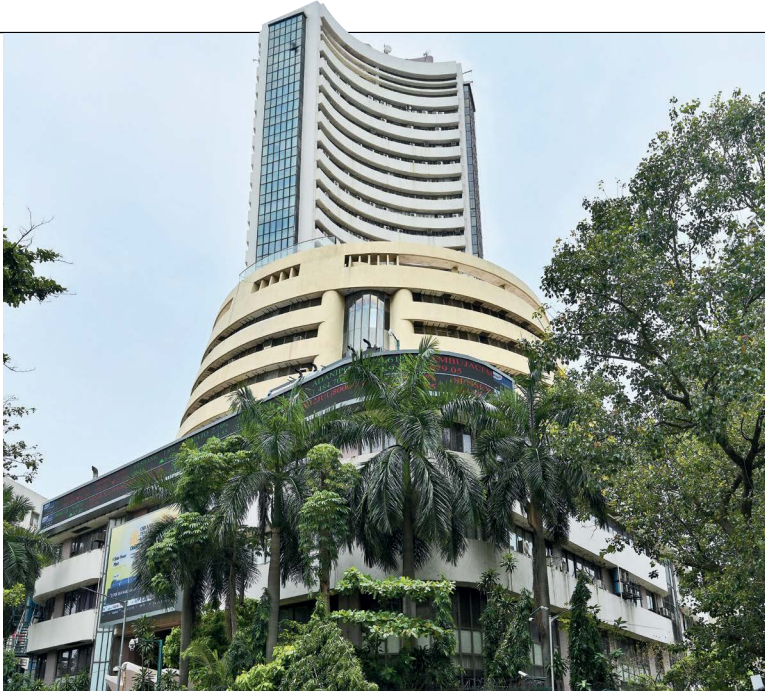




APRIL MARKET RUN

THE COMBINED MARKET valuation of Nifty 500 rose sharply in April 2026. The market cap increased from ₹372 lakh crore on March 30 to ₹415 lakh crore on April 30, a gain of 11.5%. This came after a weak performance in March, when the Nifty 500 index fell 11.40% from 23,167 to 20,528. In April, it recovered strongly, rising 10.5% to 22,684, while large cap benchmark Nifty50 rose 7.5% in this period. The rally was broad-based. As many as 472 stocks posted gains, while only 28 stocks declined. Notably, seven stocks delivered returns of over 50%.

AI RISKS CONTINUE

ANTHROPIC'S MYTHOS HAS triggered fresh concerns around AI-led cyber risks, prompting Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman to convene a high-level meeting with bank chiefs and officials from the RBI and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. While experts downplay its immediate threat potential upon public release, cybersecurity firms see it as a force multiplier for sophisticated attacks. The larger takeaway is that enterprises can no longer afford a wait-and-watch approach. AI is accelerating risks, and cybersecurity maturity must keep pace.

IMAGE BY NILANJAN DAS/AI



38.4

MILLION TONNES

PORT TRAFFIC OF PETROLEUM, OIL, AND LUBRICANTS IN MARCH 2026, DOWN 10.1% YoY FROM 42.8 MILLION TONNES A YEAR AGO, REVERSING THE 4.2% GROWTH RECORDED A MONTH EARLIER



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GAME, RESET!

MEITY HAS NOTIFIED the PROGA Act, 2025, and the new online gaming rules, effective May 1 and replaced state-level laws with a national framework. All real-money games are banned—whether of skill or chance—while only e-sports and social gaming are allowed. A new Online Gaming Authority is now in place. However, the Supreme Court is still examining claims from gaming firms and Karnataka, which argue betting is a state subject and that the rules wrongly club skill games with gambling. For now, the rules are in force, but any adverse ruling could strike them down.